

About Audit Findings Standard - (AFS)

Understanding Audit Findings Standard

What Is Audit Findings Standard?

Audit Findings Standard is the seventh Parent Standard of ADIT® — Continuous Audit & Evidence Governance Architecture™. It governs how audit findings are objectively identified, documented, classified, validated, and governed using verified evidence generated through governed audit execution.

Audit Findings Standard recognizes that completing an audit does not automatically produce reliable findings. Audit conclusions must be derived through a standardized methodology that objectively evaluates verified evidence, documents supporting rationale, and classifies findings according to established governance requirements.

Canonical Definition

Audit Findings Standard defines the governance conditions required to establish, validate, document, classify, and preserve audit findings produced through governed audit execution. It establishes finding principles, finding methodology, classification requirements, governance controls, validation mechanisms, and continuous findings assurance necessary to ensure that audit findings remain objective, evidence-based, transparent, repeatable, and independently verifiable throughout the complete lifecycle of a governed entity.

Why Audit Findings Standard Exists

Audit findings influence governance decisions, corrective actions, regulatory compliance, and organizational accountability.

Without a standardized methodology, findings may become inconsistent, subjective, or insufficiently supported by evidence. Organizations therefore require governed rules for producing findings that are objective, repeatable, transparent, and independently verifiable.

Audit Findings Standard exists to ensure that every audit finding is supported by verified evidence and generated through a governed audit methodology.

What

Audit Findings Standard Governs

Audit Findings Standard governs:

- Audit findings
 - Finding classification
 - Finding validation
 - Finding documentation
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- Finding prioritization
 - Finding governance
 - Findings assurance
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Use Case 1 — Autonomous AI Governance

Scenario

An organization completes a governance audit of an autonomous AI platform operating across multiple business units.

Application

Audit Findings Standard governs the identification, validation, classification, and documentation of audit findings based exclusively on verified evidence and governed audit execution.

Result

The organization produces objective, repeatable, and evidence-supported audit findings suitable for governance oversight and independent review.

Use Case 2 — Regulatory Compliance Audit

Scenario

A regulatory authority completes an audit of a critical infrastructure operator.

Application

Audit Findings Standard governs the methodology for documenting findings, classifying their significance, validating supporting evidence, and preserving the complete reasoning behind every audit conclusion.

Result

Regulatory findings remain transparent, objectively supported, and capable of withstanding independent scrutiny and legal review.

Architectural Position

Audit Findings Standard represents the seventh governed space within ADIT® — Continuous Audit & Evidence Governance Architecture™, transforming governed audit execution into objective, evidence-based audit conclusions before audit response begins.

Governance Flow

Audit Observation → Evidence Formation → Evidence Integrity → Evidence
Correlation → Evidence Verification → Audit Execution → Audit Findings → Audit
Response → Audit Preservation → Audit Assurance

Canonical Closing Statement

Audit Findings Standard establishes the canonical governance framework for producing objective, evidence-based audit findings. By governing finding identification, classification, validation, documentation, and continuous findings assurance, Audit Findings Standard enables reliable audit conclusions, operational reconstruction, accountable governance, and independent verification across all operational domains.

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Canonical Source

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